

services probably have a lot to offer in the way of integration. And that's certainly true enough, as you're learning throughout this book: Windows Phone connects to an amazing array of Microsoft and third-party services, and these connections are in many ways what makes Windows Phone so exciting.

When it comes to accessing Office-based documents in the cloud, however, Microsoft's consumer-oriented and business-based tools take decidedly different approaches. One is seamless and automatic, but priced according to the needs of businesses. The other is free and available to all, but is unfortunately limited as well.

Using Windows Live SkyDrive

Windows Live SkyDrive is Microsoft's online storage service and it provides everyone with a Windows Live ID with free access to 25GB of web-based storage. That sounds like a lot but Microsoft really does do everything it can to prevent users from accessing that storage efficiently or easily. For example, Microsoft provides no way to access SkyDrive storage via the Windows Explorer interface in desktop versions of Windows, preventing users from dragging and dropping files between their PC and the cloud.

Likewise, on Windows Phone, there's no integrated, seamless way to sync documents between your phone and SkyDrive. Oddly enough, Microsoft does provide this functionality for the business-oriented SharePoint service, however. Why this disparity, Simple: Whereas SkyDrive is free, corporate customers pay Microsoft a lot of money, directly or indirectly, in order to use SharePoint. Thus, their lives are made easier.

So in the world of the haves and have-nots, SkyDrive users are decidedly in the have-not camp. But that doesn't mean you can't access SkyDrive-based documents from Windows Phone. You just have a bit more work to do. Here's how to make it happen.



Viewing SkyDrive-based office documents